

Free & Low-Cost Alternative Training

You don't need a four-year degree to build a good career. Free and low-cost training — online courses, bootcamps, and certifications — can get you hired. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Many high-paying fields care more about skills and certifications than degrees. A lot of quality training is free or very cheap — the trick is knowing where to look and which credentials employers value.

1 Free Online Learning

Build real skills at no cost.

☐ Khan Academy

Completely free courses in math, science, computing, and more.

→ www.khanacademy.org

☐ Coursera & edX (Financial Aid)

University courses online; both offer financial aid for free access to paid certificates.

→ www.coursera.org/courses?query=free

☐ Google Career Certificates

Job-ready certificates in IT, data, and more — scholarships often available.

→ grow.google/certificates

2 Free Tech Training

Pathways into well-paid tech jobs without a degree.

☐ freeCodeCamp

Free, full coding curriculum with certifications.

→ www.freecodecamp.org

☐ Free Tech Bootcamps

Some bootcamps are free or pay-after-you're-hired. Search "free coding bootcamp" and verify before enrolling.

→ **Verify any bootcamp before enrolling**

3 Use Public Resources

Your library and Job Center offer surprising free training.

☐ Library Online Courses

Many libraries give free access to LinkedIn Learning, Gale Courses, and more with your library card.

→ **Ask your public library**

☐ American Job Center Training

Free WIOA-funded training for eligible people. See the Job Training guide.

→ www.careeronestop.org/LocalHelp/local-help.aspx

4 Choose Wisely

Pick training that actually leads to jobs.

☐ Check Employer Demand First

Before investing time, confirm employers in your area hire for that skill or certificate. A Job Center advisor can help free.

→ www.careeronestop.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be careful with expensive bootcamps promising “guaranteed jobs” — many overpromise. Check free options first, read reviews, and verify job-placement claims before paying or borrowing.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Pick a credential employers actually ask for, then find the cheapest legitimate way to earn it — often free through a library, Khan Academy, freeCodeCamp, or a scholarship.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national resources. For local free training and which skills are in demand near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
